# Emotional (internalising) and conduct (externalising) problems in childhood.

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## Document details

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|---|---|
| **Summary of work undertaken** | Derived variables for emotional and conduct problems |
| **Output variables** | in1315g1, ext93pcg |

## Overview

### ***Defining emotional (internalising) and conduct (externalising) problems in NSHD***

Identification of conduct and emotional problems in NSHD was based on questions asked of teachers when study members were aged 13 and 15 years, using a forerunner of the Rutter A scale (Rutter et al., 1970; Elander & Rutter, 1996). Items for conduct problems refer to unpunctuality, restlessness, truancy, daydreaming, indiscipline, disobedience and lying. Items for emotional problems refer to anxiety, timidity, fearfulness, diffidence and avoidance of attention.

Summary measures of these problems were created by deriving global measures for each from factor analysis (using the statistical package Mplus, which allows for item level missing data), then dividing scores for these into absent, mild and severe based on established percentile cuts (Ghodsian et al., 1980; Ghodsian, 1983; Rodgers, 1990; Colman et al., 2009). For conduct problems these were 0-75%, 75-93% and 94% or higher, respectively; and for emotional problems these were 0-50%, 50-87% and 88% or higher, respectively. For both sets of problems the percentile cut for ‘severe’ was guided by epidemiological evidence to capture potentially clinically diagnosable disorders.

The variable names are **in1315g1** and **ext93pcg**, for emotional and conduct problems, respectively, and are coded 0, 1 and 2 for absent, mild or severe, as above. -999 refers to missing, but the user will need to define this as such.

## References


Colman I, Murray J, Abbott R. A., Maughan B., Kuh D., Croudace T. J., Jones P. B. (2009) Outcomes of conduct problems in adolescence: forty-year follow-up of a national cohort. British Medical Journal, 338: a2981

Elander J., Rutter M. Use and development of the Rutter parents’ and teachers’ scales. (1996) International Journal of Methods in Psychiatric Research, 6:63-78

Ghodsian M. Measuring behaviour in the school and home. In: Fogelman K, ed. Growing Up in Britain. London, England: The Macmillan Press Ltd: 1983, pp 329-338

Ghodsian M., Fogelman K., Lambert L. & Tibbenham A. (1980) Changes in behaviour rating of a national sample of children. British Journal of Clinical Psychology, 19: 247-56

Rodgers, B. (1990) Behaviour and personality in childhood as predictors of adult psychiatric disorder. Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, 31: 393-414.

Rutter M., Tizard J. & Whitmore K. (1970) Education, health and behaviour London: Longman.


## Variables in this document

### 2 high-confidence matches

| Variable | Label | How it was found |
|---|---|---|
| **Questionnaire data [55] › Mental health [520] › Childhood mental health and personality [5209]** | | |
| ext93pcg | Conduct (externalising) problems - at age 13 and 15 years | topsheet field |
| in1315g1 | Emotional (internalising) problems - at age 13 and 15 years | topsheet field |

## 2 medium-confidence matches

| Variable | Label | How it was found |
|---|---|---|
| **Clinical data [51] › Physical measures [110] › Anthropometry [1102] › Body size measures [11021]** | | |
| scales | Serial number of scales - at age 53 years | prose scan |
| **Clinical data [51] › Physical measures [110] › Hand examination [1106]** | | |
| problems | Any problems identifed with the hands - Hands Examinations 1999 | prose scan |